



ASUS Eee PC 1000H

PC is its multi-touch track pad which allows you to use gestures by sliding multiple fingers simultaneously, like you would do on the new Apple devices.

The keypad is one of the most usable, of all the netbooks we tested. There are dedicated buttons for changing screen resolution, Skype, performance modes and also to turn off the screen. There is no button or shortcut to disable the touchpad though. There are some small differences between these siblings though – the webcam is a 1.3-MP on the 1000H and a 0.3-MP on the 904HA, the latter also misses out on Bluetooth.

The biggest differences between the two are their screen size and battery. We recommend the Rs. 23,990 1000H as are you aren't saving any baggage space by picking the 9-inch 904HA. On the other hand, if you value battery life above all, then the 904HA is the one to buy. That's available for Rs. 20,490.

BenQ Joybook Lite U101

BenQ is best known for the LCD screens and optical drives but not so much for laptops in India. At first glimpse, things look very good for their new netbook. The first thing you notice about the BenQ Joybook U101 is its beautiful surface; complete with accented patterns under its blue glossy finish. It gives the netbook a unique look and makes it feel more personal.

With the lid opened, the inside of the laptop resembles the LG XNote and the Lenovo IdeaPad S10. It doesn't look a lot different from the LG and the Lenovo here. A metallic power button, two sets of LEDs, rounded edges and a rounded combined mouse button are some of things that stand out when you look at it.

The screen of the Joybook is 16:9 and runs at a resolution of 1024 x 576. This is a little less vertical workspace than the other 1024 x 600 displays.

This might be great for movie buffs but not so great when you need the most workspace available for other applications. While rest of the hardware remains the same as the other netbooks, the Joybook Lite U101 is one of the



BenQ Joybook Lite U101

only ones to give you more than a gigabyte of memory to start with. The U101 comes with 1.5 GB of RAM which can be upgraded to 2 GB. This doesn't show any drastic improvements over other netbooks in performance.

Although the performance in all tests match the other netbooks, the battery life test shows that the 3-cell Joybook Lite lasts for just over two hours. That's a bit better than 10-inch Lenovo S10 and a lot more than the LG X110.

The BenQ has nothing more to offer in terms of performance or features. A set of necessary feature and looks is what it has going for it mostly. Being a very new product, BenQ hasn't provided us a price for the Joybook Lite

U101. Still, the BenQ Joybook Lite in our opinion is a good option should the price be around the Rs. 20,000 mark.

LG X110

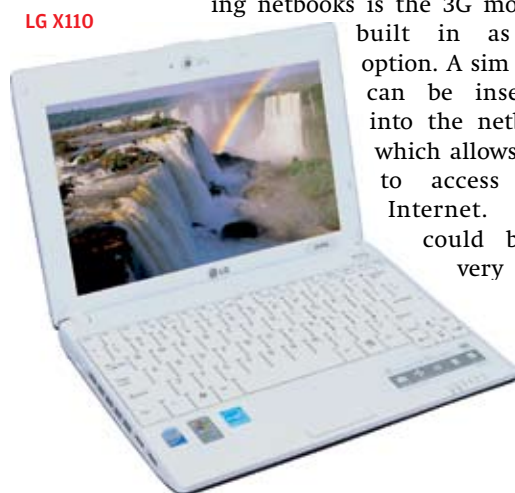
LG isn't very aggressive in the laptop market but their new netbook is an interesting one. The LG X110 is one of the best looking netbooks around and one which is very comparable to the Lenovo IdeaPad and the BenQ Joybook. One notable aspect of this netbook is a neat array of LEDs lining its bottom, and a glowing blue power button.

The entire look of the LG X110 makes it almost a Mac-like laptop when opened. The white is bound to get dirty over time, though. The touchpad is good and has a single piece button with two mouse buttons. The design and feel of the touchpad is great and is effortless to use. A hotkey can be used to disable the touchpad if you choose to use an external mouse instead; a welcome touch.

Its speakers are one of the weaker points of the LG X110. They are very loud but they have a very shrill treble output and don't make for good music listening. Another kink in the LG is that the netbook has a front end where you normally rest your palm that sticks up from the surface you place it on. Typing becomes a little uncomfortable this way. Some other manufacturers have chosen to bevel that edge so you can rest your palm.

A feature not seen on competing netbooks is the 3G modem built in as an option. A sim card can be inserted into the netbook which allows you to access the Internet. This could be a very use-

ful feature



LG X110

when 3G services finally arrive in India.

The keyboard feels well built with nice, firm keys. The netbook has plenty of wide open vents at its bottom such that there is almost no heat given out off the top of the netbook. Having said that, the area underneath does get a little hot. All in all, excluding the audio quality and low battery life, the X110 is a pretty decent netbook that rivals the BenQ Joybook for looks.

Lenovo IdeaPad S10

The Lenovo IdeaPad S10 grabs your attention with its deep-blue top and chrome-finished Lenovo badge. The beauty runs to the inside as well though, with good attention to detail in places such as the camera, for example, which has a nice chrome ring around it.

Looks aren't everything and it doesn't take too long to notice a few functionality issues with the S10. The buttons on the touchpad are hard and the Function key is placed on the extreme left of the keyboard instead of the Control key—if you are used to desktop keyboards, your hand will invariably hit Function when you wanted to reach for the Control button. This is a problem also seen on the MSI Wind.

The F12 key, although not used often, is missing from the keyboard. It is only available as a hotkey. The Tab key is also much smaller. All these reductions seem to have benefited the rest of the keyboard layout – it's spacious. The keyboard also feels sturdy with little travel to the keys.

Performance figures for this netbook were also identical to most of its competitors. A detail to note here: 3D Mark 2005 refused to run due to the as the netbook lacked the minimum of 128 MB video memory required for the benchmark. We couldn't set the video memory beyond 64 MB.

There aren't any hotspots around the notebook. The only bit of heat can be felt on the sides



Lenovo IdeaPad S10

of the unit; nothing around the touchpad, which is a good thing. There is a compact and lightweight battery on the Lenovo S10 which kept the S10 running for 1 hr 48 minutes in our tests; which is a decent time.

There are many netbooks with better battery life and these are available for a lot less than the S10. At Rs. 26,000, it's definitely expensive and is worth only looks matter the most to you.

MSI Wind U100

The MSI Wind is a 10-inch netbook and was one of the first netbooks available in India. Back when it launched, it was one of the favourites for its design. The Wind has a rounded and bevelled motif which many users seem to prefer to the more compact and bright glossy finishes found in competing netbooks.

The build quality of the Wind is average. One of the problems is that the hinge for the LCD screen is pretty weak and wobbles at the slightest opportunity. The keyboard isn't so good either. Still, the keyboard feels a little better than the ASUS Eee PC. Much like the Lenovo S10, this netbook has the Function on the left as well, which takes getting used to. The directional keys are smaller and narrower and might not be so good for any simple games

that you might want to play on.

The screen is decent but can be a little too bright, to be of comfort. There are LEDs for almost every kind of indication that you may need to see. The audio too doesn't sound great and it tends to emphasise the highs a bit.

In terms of performance, the only place where the MSI Wind lacked power was in the drive related tests. For example, SiSoft Sandra showed a 39 MB/s drive index score whereas the others were around 50 MB/s.



MSI Wind U100

LAPTOP SERVICE TRAINING @ CORONA



Admit it, the laptop revolution is here to stay, and it is time for even an average hardware engineer to equip himself with the laptop service and handling knowledge. so.....

Update now or stay behind.

■ 45 hour intensive training in laptop service that convert a normal hardware professional in to a full fledged laptop technician, including the chip level service of logic components.

- Regular and fast track sessions for professionals
- Custom designed sessions for corporate training
- Accommodation facility for out station students.

Course level : Intermediate to expert

CORONA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
Kottayam, Kerala, India-688 001

Dial us at 0481-2566388, 2304583

Or talk to our in-charge @ 098471-55469

Visit : www.laptopservicetraining.com for more details